

Suren Joshi's Carisma

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His girlfriends call it the "Disco car" from the hit song in the movie *Kal Ho Na Ho*. He just calls it a fast, entertaining car. And his nickname in the big bad world of modified cars is Landspeed.

To call Suren Joshi a car freak would be under-rating the word—he is more than that. He is devoted to his car, and at an age when his peers would be chasing girls, or even jobs, Joshi spends half his time modifying his car, and the remaining half in his other favourite pastime—sleeping.

It helps that he, along with his mother, owns a garments export business with factories in the south Indian city of Tirupur, and Mumbai. Money, therefore, is only the small matter of how much to withdraw from the ATM.

He has always been different, this Suren Joshi. Which is why when most people who want to modify their cars with one screen for people to watch movies, he installed three in his 90-bhp Mitsubishi Lancer. Not satisfied with it, he also installed a Rs 22,000 DVD player. And just in case people called him a visual person rather than an audio enthusiast, he installed 2000-watt speakers with amplifiers, which cost him a further Rs 57,000.

Joshi, now 21, has been a technology addict ever since his teenage days when he hacked into the servers of a local daily newspaper in Mumbai, and then promptly called up the editor to inform him about it. The editor did not waste time hiring him and asking him to plug all the loopholes in their information systems.

At 17, he was a Microsoft Certified Software Engineer, and in addition to his ethical hacking, Joshi says he even helped the Mumbai Police solve a kidnapping case by tracking down the kidnapper's whereabouts through his email messages.

Two years ago, he gave up

studying for good ("I am just a 12th standard pass") and left for the United States to do a course in modelling. He came back with a diploma from the Barbizon School of Modelling, a leading modelling institution. His latest passion is to enter the world of fashion modelling full-time.

In the meanwhile, the car receives as much attention as a first-born would from her parents. He recently installed an RPM Auto gauge that monitors his gear movements; a voltage meter that allows him to check the fluctuations; steering wheel, gears

LCDs, DVD players, 2000 watt speaker system, neon pedals, NOS—this aspiring model has a car that has his neighbours and friends drooling

"I only laugh when people ask me weird questions like 'Why do you have so many clocks in your car?'"



Inside 21-year-old Landspeed's "Disco car"

and hand control set from Momo, another world leader in car racing accessories. He has even installed neon light fittings to his clutch, brake and accelerator pedals.

He has spruced up the Lancer engine into a 125 Bhp beast - thanks to a Performance Filter with spark cables, a sturtbar, a Zulex and HID lights. has transformed his 85-90 horsepower Lancer to a 125 horsepower flying one. His analogue dials, however, elicit "weird questions from my friends like 'Why do you have so many clocks in your car'," says Joshi. "I can only laugh."

By the way, the rest can envy Suren. ■

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Gadgets

Car
90-bhp Mitsubishi Lancer

Audio System
Pioneer 2000 watt Speakers with amplifiers- Rs 57,000
Pioneer DVD player- Rs 22,000

Other Drolware
3 LCD screens (Rs 46,000), HID Lights- Rs 20,000, American make NOS- Rs 80,000, RPM Auto gauge; voltage meter hand control set from Momo, neon light fittings to his clutch, brake and accelerator pedals.

